

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 592

By Harshbarger

A RESOLUTION to designate March 12, 2026, as "Be the One to End Suicide Day" in Tennessee.

WHEREAS, on June 1, 2023, the American Legion began an initiative called Be The One with the mission to end veteran suicide; and

WHEREAS, the American Legion Department of Tennessee's Be The One Commission to End Veterans Suicide, with a motto of "Veterans Offering Lifesaving Service," was launched on August 16, 2025, with one of its missions to end veteran suicide; and

WHEREAS, nationally, approximately twenty-two veterans a day commit suicide; and

WHEREAS, suicide is the second leading cause of death for children and young adults aged ten to twenty-four, behind unintentional injuries, with an estimated 6,500 individuals in that demographic taking their own lives every year; and

WHEREAS, the suicide rate in Tennessee is 14.7 percent above the national rate, according to 2025 data from the Tennessee Department of Health; and

WHEREAS, the American Legion Department of Tennessee is committed to end suicide in every demographic from the young to the old alike; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby designate March 12, 2026, as "Be The One to End Suicide Day" in the Volunteer State and urge public and private entities across Tennessee's ninety-five counties to hold suicide prevention training annually, promote the 988 suicide prevention hotline, and display awareness messaging in appropriate locations.